

- 61** Ambrosia beetles carry fungal spores from tree to tree. The beetles make holes in the branches of trees and create a network of tunnels in the wood. The fungus grows along the walls of the tunnels providing the only food source for the beetles. The fungus can penetrate xylem vessels and block them, which eventually kills the tree.

Which option correctly describes the relationship between these organisms?

- A** The beetle and the fungus have a mutualistic relationship.
- B** The beetle and the tree have a mutualistic relationship.
- C** The fungus is a parasite on the beetle.
- D** The fungus is the primary producer that the beetle feeds on.
- E** The tree is the primary producer that the beetle feeds on.